

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 851

By Bricken

A RESOLUTION to recognize Dr. Gary Arnold Flandro for his foundational role in the development of NASA's Voyager program.

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those individuals whose vision and intellect have advanced human knowledge and brought distinction to this State and nation; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Gary Arnold Flandro, a renowned aerospace engineer and professor emeritus at the University of Tennessee Space Institute (UTSI), is one such individual, having made groundbreaking contributions to space exploration and scientific advancement; and

WHEREAS, born on March 30, 1934, in Salt Lake City, Utah, Dr. Flandro earned a Bachelor of Science degree in Mechanical Engineering from the University of Utah in 1957, followed by a Master of Science degree and Doctor of Philosophy degree in Aeronautics from the California Institute of Technology, where his research addressed critical instabilities in rocket motor design; and

WHEREAS, in 1964, while working as a summer student at the Jet Propulsion Laboratory, Dr. Gary Flandro discovered a rare planetary alignment among the outer planets, an occurrence that happens only once every 175 years; and

WHEREAS, this discovery, which became known as the "Grand Tour," made it possible to design a mission using gravity-assist maneuvers to reach multiple outer planets in a single flight path, a concept that laid the groundwork for what would become NASA's historic Voyager program; and

WHEREAS, despite initial skepticism from experts, Dr. Flandro persisted in demonstrating the feasibility and scientific promise of the mission, ultimately influencing one of the most successful space exploration initiatives in history; and

WHEREAS, in recognition of this discovery and its impact, Dr. Gary Flandro received the British Interplanetary Society's M. N. Golovine Award in 1970 and was awarded the NASA Exceptional Achievement Medal in 1998 for his seminal contributions to multi-outer-planet mission design; and

WHEREAS, his academic career included serving as the Boling Chair of Excellence in Space Propulsion at UTSI, where he advanced the study of rocket propulsion and mentored the next generation of engineers and scientists; and

WHEREAS, he currently serves as Vice President and Chief Engineer of Gloyer-Taylor Laboratories; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Flandro's professional achievements have also earned him the General Henry H. H. Arnold Award and fellowship in the American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Gary Flandro's lifetime of scientific innovation and commitment to education has brought honor to the State of Tennessee and inspired generations of engineers, students, and space enthusiasts alike; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Dr. Gary Arnold Flandro for his extraordinary contributions to aerospace engineering and his critical role in the formation of NASA's Voyager program, extending our gratitude for his lasting legacy in science and higher education and our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.